CONSULTATION

Your peer consultation charter

How to agree a short charter for a peer consultation group: purpose, confidentiality, time and how disagreements are handled.

AUDIENCE	FORMAT	VERSION	TIME
Psychologists · Psychiatrists	Guide and template	1.0 · Nov 2026	30 minutes with the group

WHAT IT IS	A guide for writing a one-page charter that every member of a consultation group can agree to.
USE IT WHEN	When a new group forms, when members join, and once a year to review it together.
CUSTOMIZE FIRST	The group's purpose, how often it meets and how it handles case material. The full template is PA-04.

1. Establish a shared purpose

- [ ] Agree what the group is for: case consultation, professional support, skills or a mix.
- [ ] Agree who can join and how new members are invited.
- [ ] Agree the meeting rhythm, length and format (virtual, in person or hybrid).

2. Create consistent boundaries

- [ ] Confidentiality: what is shared in the group stays in the group.
- [ ] Case material is de-identified: no names, dates of birth, employers, or details that together identify a client.
- [ ] Consultation does not transfer clinical responsibility: each member stays responsible for their own clients.
- [ ] Attendance: what members do if they cannot come, and how the group responds to repeated absence.

3. Share the time well

- [ ] Agree a simple structure, for example: check-in, one or two case presentations, reflection.
- [ ] Agree how presenters frame a question (PA-05 helps).
- [ ] Agree how the group gives feedback: curious, specific and respectful.

4. Review together

- [ ] Revisit the charter once a year or when membership changes.
- [ ] Agree how concerns about a member's conduct are raised, privately and early.
- [ ] Record the agreed version in the group's PsyAlliance card so every member can read it.

BEFORE YOU USE IT

A consultation group is not a substitute for formal supervision where your license requires it, and consultation does not move clinical responsibility to the group. Keep all case material de-identified. Check your licensing board's rules if the group will count towards continuing education or supervision hours. This guide is educational and is not legal or clinical advice.

NOTES